JunctionX Turku – Case Partner Challenge Brief Template

Redstone x A'Pelago Challenge: Build the Ocean Opportunity Radar

Build an intelligent tool that assesses startups and reveals the best next opportunities for funding, investment, partnerships and growth.

Description

At A'Pelago and Redstone, we regularly assess startups to understand their commercial potential, team, impact, investment readiness and fit with our investment and accelerator support.

Today, this work requires combining information from databases, pitch decks, company websites, LinkedIn, financial data and other sources, then manually assessing potential investors, funding opportunities and strategic partners. This is time-consuming, difficult to scale and makes it harder to consistently compare opportunities across sectors and markets and offer the best possible support for the growth companies.

Build a prototype that turns fragmented startup and ecosystem data into actionable venture intelligence, helping users (fund and accelerator operators) identify which opportunities are most promising, understand why they matter, and determine what should happen next.

Your solution could help answer questions such as:

- **Which startups and opportunities are most promising?**
- **Why are they promising, and how do they fit the relevant investment or accelerator thesis?**
- **What is their Ocean Impact Readiness Level, Business Readiness Level, Technological Readiness and Investment Readiness level?**
- **Which investors, funding opportunities, strategic partners or potential clients could be relevant for them next and in which prioritized order?**
- **What should the startup or ecosystem actor do next?**

Insight

This is not a “summarise a pitch deck with AI” task. That is too easy and would create limited value.

The hard part is connecting different types of information and turning them into a **decision-ready picture**: assessing a venture against an accelerator/investment thesis, understanding its ocean impact and readiness, and identifying relevant next steps such as investors, grants, funding programmes or strategic partners.

The best solutions will go beyond scoring startups. They will help users **discover connections and opportunities that would otherwise be difficult to see**.

Judging criteria

3–5 concrete, checkable criteria tied to what the company actually wants from challenge.

- **Creativity:** Does the solution offer an innovative approach to turning fragmented venture data into useful intelligence?
- **Usability:** Can an investor, accelerator or other ecosystem actor understand the output quickly and use it to make a decision or take action? How precisely does the tool evaluate the company?
- **Actionability:** Does the solution produce strategically meaningful next steps, such as relevant investors, funding opportunities or potential partners?
- **Scalability:** Could the solution be applied beyond blue economy startups, across different industries, markets or use cases?
- **Technical execution:** How effectively does the prototype combine available data, AI and/or other technologies into a functional solution?
- **Visual appeal:** How clear and onbrand are the tool outputs?

Resources

Teams may work with a combination of startup and ecosystem data such as:

- **Startup data:** open LinkedIn informatiRedstoon, company websites, publicly available pitch decks, selected financial/company data such as EU BlueInvest, Dealroom, Traxn, Pitchbook, Crunchbase, and others
- **Assessment frameworks:**

    - **Ocean Impact Readiness Level:** Ocean Impact Navigator: https://www.1000oceanstartups.org/navigator
    - **Business Readiness Level:** https://kthinnovationreadinesslevel.com/wp-content/uploads/sites/9/2018/10/Business-readiness-Level.pdf
    - **Technological Readiness:** https://www.aalto.fi/en/services/technology-readiness-level-trl
    - **Investment Potential:** Market, Product, Team, Business Model, Competition, Marketing & Distribution, Financials, Tech, Deal Dynamics, Impact
- **Funding landscape:** relevant blue economy and other grant opportunities, including Business Finland, EU funding, as well as other global suitable funding sources
- **Investor landscape:** relevant Finnish, European and global angels, VCs and other investors
- **Strategic Partner and Client landscape:** potential corporate, research and ecosystem partners and Clients

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Prizes

Cash and/or non-cash.

- **5,000 € worth of 1:1 consulting** from Redstone and A'Pelago
- **Priority consideration in the application process for one of A'Pelago Spring 2027 accelerator programmes,** depending on the team's fit and stage

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About the company

A'Pelago is the leading blue economy ecosystem and accelerator in the Baltic Sea connecting startups, investors, companies, researchers and other ecosystem actors to accelerate solutions for a healthier ocean and sustainable blue economy. Through its accelerator programmes, ecosystem activities and international networks, A'Pelago helps ventures access knowledge, partnerships, funding and markets.

Redstone Blue is an early-stage venture capital firm focused on identifying and supporting high-potential blue economy companies. Redstone brings an investment perspective to the challenge, with experience in evaluating startups, teams, markets and opportunities for growth.

At Junction, A'Pelago and Redstone are looking for new ways to make venture assessment and ecosystem matchmaking more data-driven, scalable and actionable.